



Environment
Canada

Environnement
Canada

Fisheries and
Marine

Pêches et
sciences de la mer

Pacific Biological Station,
Nanaimo, B.C.

October 1, 1973.

Your file: *Votre référence:*

Our file: *Notre référence:*

41-3-11

Dr. Kenneth A. Henry,
National Marine Fisheries Service,
Northwest Fisheries Center,
2725 Montlake Boulevard East,
Seattle, Washington, 98112. U.S.A.

Dear Ken:

Enclosed is a statement regarding escapements
to the Canadian section of the Yukon River. This is in
response to your request of July 26, 1973.

Yours very truly,

K. V. Aro.

KVA/bw

cc Regnaud

1090 West Pender Street
Vancouver 1, B.C.

RECEIVED
MAY 1 1974

DIVISION OF COMM. FISH
Alaska Dept. of Fish & Game
Fairbanks, Alaska

1090 rue West Pender
Vancouver 1, (C.-B.)

ESCAPEMENTS OF CHINOOKS AND CHUMS TO THE
CANADIAN PORTION OF THE YUKON RIVER DRAINAGE

Because of the large size and remoteness of the Yukon River drainage it has not been possible to obtain complete escapement figures for chinook and chum spawning in the system in any one year. In recent years emphasis has been placed mainly into identifying spawning areas and, to a lesser extent, to determining the size of the runs.

✓ To-date 56 separate spawning grounds have been identified for chinook and 10 for chum (see Appendix I). These including spawning areas on the mainstem of the Yukon River where large segments of both runs are believed to spawn.

Records of numbers of salmon in the Canadian portion of the Yukon River are comprised of the following:

- (1) Commercial and Native subsistence catches of salmon (see Appendix III).
- (2) Chinook counts through the Whitehorse Dam fishway since 1959 (see Appendix II).
- (3) Fence counts in 1972 on the Nisutlin and Fishing Branch Rivers (see Appendix II).
- (4) Spawning stream surveys by foot, boat and aircraft. These have not been included as estimates can be very variable. As is well known only a small portion of the spawner actually present can be seen during surveys.

Based on the size of the commercial catch, the number of known spawning grounds and recent tagged to untagged recoveries

✓ in the upper Yukon River the magnitude of the escapement into Canadian territory has tentatively been set at 50,000 - 100,000 chinook and 200,000 - 500,000 chum, annually.

KNOWN SALMON SPAWNING GROUNDS IN THE YUKON RIVER SYSTEM, 1973.Yukon River Mainstem:

near Coffee Creek	chum
near Ingersoll Islands	chinook
near Yukon Crossing	chum

Klondike:

North Klondike R.	chinook
Klondike R.	chinook and chum
✓ Sixty Mile R.	chum
✓ Miller Cr.	"

Stewart:

Mayo R.	chinook
✓ Janet Cr.	"
Pleasant Cr.	"
Hess R.	"
Rogue R.	"

Pelly:

Little Kalzas R.	chinook
Kalzas R.	"
Moose R.	"
Russell R.	"
Husky Dog R.	"
South MacMillan R.	"
Riddell Cr.	"
✓ Mica Cr.	"
Earn R.	"
✓ Harvey Cr.	"
Tay R.	"
Glenlyon R.	"
Blind Cr.	"
Lapie R.	"
Ross R.	"
Prevost R.	"

Hoole R.	chinook
^ Woodside R.	"
Sheldon Lk.	"
Lewis Lk.	"
Ollie Lk.	"

Carmacks Area:

Tatchun Cr.	chinook
Nordenskiold R.	"
Little Salmon R.	"
North Big Salmon R.	"
South Big Salmon R.	"
Big Salmon R.	"

Teslin:

Teslin R.	chinook and (chum)
Nisutlin R.	chinook
Sidney Cr.	"
Rose Cr.	"
McConnell R.	"
McNeil R.	"
Wolf R.	"
Red R.	"
Morley R.	"
Swift R.	"
McNaughton Cr.	"
Jennings R.	"
Hayes R.	"
Gladys R.	"

Whitehorse:

Takhini R.	chinook
McClintock R.	"
Mitchie Cr.	"

Kluane:

Tincup Cr.	chinook
Kluane R.	chum
Koidern R.	"
Nisling R.	chinook

Porcupine:

Fishing Branch	chum and coho
Miner R.	chinook
Old Crow R.	"
✓ Bell R.	chum